

■ By Sharda Ugra

So, ready for global domination? Stand back world, here we come, tricolour fluttering. Well, the script says so, doesn't it? Now that Australia has been knocked over, back to back, on their own turf, all that remains is to kick the throne from under them, snatch the crown off their head and push them off stage, just like they did to that nice Mr Pawar. Then, wait for the 2011 World Cup to roll around—and claim what is rightly ours.

Even India's cricketers, no matter how young or intox-

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NEW WORLD

The CB series victory may be hailed as the beginning of a new era, but to claim undisputed supremacy India will need a streak of victories around the globe for seasons at a stretch

icated by the CB series victory and all subsequent champagne, would hold up a hand to appeal for sobriety.

India's triumph has been hailed as many things: from national payback to the best day Down Under since the 1985 World Championship of Cricket. It has been marked down as the occasion when the Australians rubbed their jaws ruefully only to find that they felt like

glass the day when the game's balance of power shifted, the moment the baton was passed in Indian cricket.

It may well turn out to be, but, all that the CB series is at this moment, is one of India's most significant limited-overs campaigns and a shiny trophy carried around the Gabba ground by a serene Sachin Tendulkar much like an emperor would a diadem and sceptre. The win is,

in fact, a base camp, a starting point from where India can begin an assault on that most rarefied of peaks: to become a team of dominators like only two in the history of cricket, West Indies and Australia. Victory India is familiar with, immortality requires much more.

"A beginning has been made," says Javagal Srinath, former India pacer, now ICC match referee, who